

Yubico introduces open source SDK for securing cryptographic keys

Yubico, a leading provider of hardware authentication security keys, has launched a new open source YubiHSM 2 software development kit (SDK), which is available for engineers and developers to seamlessly implement the YubiHSM 2 for an unlimited number of use cases.

The YubiHSM 2, a hardware security module, provides a high level of security for cryptographic digital key generation,



management and storage. It supports a vast range of enterprise

applications and environments, in a cost-effective and minimalistic form factor.

Yubico's latest solution can be used for the security of cryptographic keys that are stored on servers which are used in cloud server infrastructures and data centres, as well as industrial and manufacturing services.

YubiHSM 2 SDK will help developers to rapidly develop applications across a variety of platforms and architectures, and to easily integrate with the YubiHSM 2. For applications that communicate through Public-Key Cryptography Standards (PKCS) #11, the developers can now use a SDK for integrating to the YubiHSM 2 and use all of its security abilities for better protection of cryptographic keys, etc.

Commenting on the development, Jerrod Chong, SVP of products, Yubico, said, "Open sourcing the SDK will help developers build more secure solutions in a rapid fashion. We are always looking at ways to increase the usability of our products, while maintaining a high level of trust between Yubico and our user community of developers and security specialists."

Though the protection of root keys for Microsoft Active Directory Certificate Services (ADCS) is a common use case, the YubiHSM 2 can also be used as a complete cryptographic toolbox for a broad range of commercial and open source applications, spread across different products and services.

was a service that let app developers distribute beta versions of apps, get crash reports and analytics. Following its acquisition of Skype, Microsoft used HockeyApp to test Skype's suite of mobile apps. The company has been planning to merge the service into its own platform, Visual Studio App Center. Last year, Microsoft announced Visual Studio App Center as the future of HockeyApp.

According to Microsoft, App Center will not only let developers continue distributing their builds to testers, dig into crash reports and view user download analytics as in HockeyApp, but they can also utilise App Center's new build, test and push services. "Distribution, crashes and analytics are just a part of the story. We've built App Center with powerful new features and services that help you build better apps in record time," the company said.

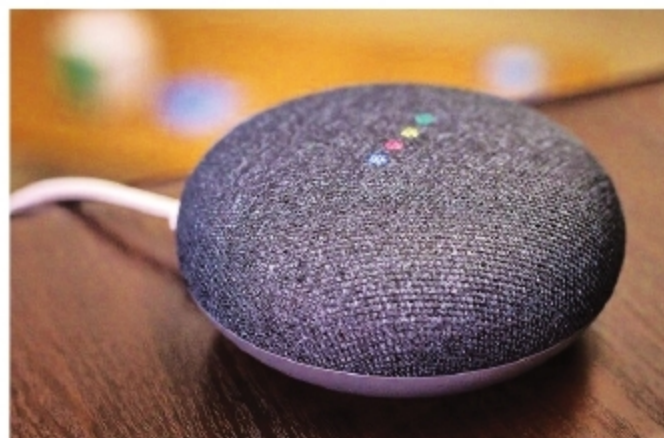
For the time being, users will be able to use HockeyApp and App Center at the same time.

Announcing the change in a blog post, the HockeyApp team said, "Starting in early 2019, you will be able to complete your migration by moving all of your apps fully to App Center. This will remove the syncing with HockeyApp, and will give you full control of your apps in App Center. You'll be able to finish moving all your apps whenever you're ready, until November 16, 2019."

Google open sources speaker diarisation AI technology

In a recent blog post, Google announced that it has open sourced its speaker diarisation technology, which is able to differentiate people's voices at a highly accurate rate.

Speaker diarisation is the process of partitioning an audio recording with the voices of multiple people into the distinct segments associated with each individual.



It is an important part of speech recognition systems.

This AI technology solves the problem of 'who spoke when' and it has applications in many important scenarios, such as understanding medical conversation, video captioning and more.

Google noted that training voice dictation systems with supervised learning methods is challenging. In a blog, Chong Wang, research scientist at Google AI, explained, "Unlike standard supervised classification tasks, a robust diarisation model requires the ability to associate new individuals with distinct speech segments that weren't involved in training. Importantly, this limits the quality of both online and offline diarisation systems. Online systems usually suffer more, since they require diarisation results in real time."

Google has developed a research paper called 'Fully Supervised Speaker Diarisation' in which it describes a new model that uses supervised speaker labels in a more effective manner.

On the NIST SRE 2000 CALLHOME benchmark, Google's techniques achieved a diarisation error rate (DER) as low as 7.6 per cent, compared to an 8.8 per cent DER from its previous clustering-based method, and 9.9 per cent from deep neural network embedding methods.

Now, Google has open sourced the core algorithms and made them available on GitHub to accelerate more research in this field.

In Google's method, all speakers' embeddings are modelled by a parameter-sharing recurrent neural network (RNN), and different speakers are distinguished using different RNN states, interleaved in the time domain. Each speaker starts